

BEADED EVENINGWEAR

DANCE DRESS

This iconic evening gown, designed by the London company Reville and Rossiter around c. 1925–28, has all the hallmarks of a Jazz-era “flapper dress”. Popular features were thin, fluid textiles like this cream silk chiffon, deep V-necks, and a dropped waist. This tubular, slip-on dress falls straight from the shoulders and has little shaping. Geometric motifs in embroidery, silvery beading, diamanté studs, and fringing grab the attention – elements that would create a spectacular display on the dance floor.



V-neckline emphasized by embroidered and beaded band

Short cap sleeves showed off dancers' arms

Row of silver and diamanté studs

Panel of scrolled beadwork down the front elongates torso

Delicate silk chiffon in soft ivory colour

Silver glass bugle beads

Triangle of black silk covered with beads draws attention to the dropped waist



BACK VIEW

SIDE VIEW

IN DETAIL



◁ **CAPPED SLEEVES**
Small, capped sleeves trimmed in silver and diamanté studs were typical of the period. The new revealing style not only showed off bare arms but also encouraged women to experiment with the newly available razors and deodorants.